

Urgent Suspected Lung Cancer Referral Pathway

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Standard Operating Procedure

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Urgent Suspected Lung Cancer Referral Pathway

1. **Aim**

To ensure timely assessment and investigation of patients referred on a suspected lung cancer pathway, in line with national targets.

2. **Scope**

This SOP applies to all healthcare professionals involved in the Lung Cancer referral and diagnostic process, including GPs, Radiologists, Consultants, and Lung MDT coordinators.

3. **Referral Pathways**

Patients may be referred via one of the following routes.

- a. Urgent Suspect Cancer Referral
- b. Consultant Upgrade
- c. Radiology Upgrade

4. **Step-by-Step Process**

Referral Received

- Referral is received either by the GP Urgent Suspect Cancer form, Consultant upgrade form, or Radiology upgrade flag.
- The referral is received by the Lung MDT Coordinator.

Notification

- The Lung MDT Coordinator emails the Lung Cancer Consultant with referral details on the same day (Monday to Friday, excluding bank holidays).

Triage

- Lung Cancer Consultant reviews the referral.
- The Lung Cancer Consultant may take the following actions.
 - Accept referral directly to Lung Cancer clinic
 - Request a CT Thorax (default: non-contrast low dose CT thorax unless otherwise clinically indicated).
- Triage by Lung Cancer Consultant should usually occur within **24 hours**.

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CT Thorax Booking

- CT scan arranged within **72 hours** of triage.
- Imaging team books and performs scan urgently.
- Radiology reporting should usually occur within **72 hours** of scan.

Lung Cancer Clinic Appointment

- Clinic appointment arranged within 7 days of referral, typically after CT scan completed.
- The objective of the clinic appointment is the initial assessment with a Respiratory Consultant, further planning, and investigation.

5. Timeframes Summary

Step

Lung Cancer Consultant Triage
 CT Thorax arranged
 Radiology Reporting
 Lung Cancer Clinic

Target Time

≤ 24 hours from referral
 ≤ 72 hours from triage
 ≤ 72 hours from CT
 ≤ 7 days from referral

6. Diagram (Flowchart)

